

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1603

By Brooks

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Akilah DaSilva, DeEbony Groves, Joe Perez, and Taurean Sanderlin on the eighth anniversary of their deaths.

WHEREAS, on April 22, 2018, a tragic act of gun violence occurred at a Waffle House in Antioch, Tennessee, now known as the Waffle House mass shooting, taking the lives of four innocent individuals and injuring others; and

WHEREAS, each of these four individuals was under thirty years of age and had a long future ahead; and

WHEREAS, these victims—Akilah DaSilva, DeEbony Groves, Joe Perez, and Taurean Sanderlin—were beloved sons, daughters, friends, and members of our community whose lives were full of promise and purpose; and

WHEREAS, a student at Middle Tennessee State University, where he was pursuing a degree in computer engineering, Akilah DaSilva was a young man known for his kindness, ambition, creativity, and love for his family; and

WHEREAS, formerly an exceptional student, star basketball player, and role model at Gallatin High School, DeEbony Groves attended Belmont University, where she impressed her peers and professors as a brilliant young woman with immense potential; and

WHEREAS, a native of Austin, Texas, Joe Perez worked as a subcontractor for a flood relocation and logistics company; he had attended Jack C. Hays High School and possessed a whimsical sense of humor; and

WHEREAS, a five-year employee of Waffle House who worked as a cook, Taurean Sanderlin of Goodlettsville was renowned for his work ethic; his friendly demeanor earned him the affection of the Antioch location's regular customers, who knew him as "T"; and

WHEREAS, sadly, these four fine young people were denied the opportunity to live and excel as contributing members of our society, but they unified the community in expressing its collective love, respect, and sorrow at the passing of Akilah DaSilva, DeEbony Groves, Joe Perez, and Taurean Sanderlin, who live on in the hearts and minds of their family, friends, and fellow Nashvillians and Tennesseans; and

WHEREAS, their lives were tragically cut short, leaving an immeasurable void in the hearts of those who knew and loved them; and

WHEREAS, the families of these victims have shown extraordinary strength, resilience, and courage in the face of unimaginable grief; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we honor the memories of these four precious lives lost as we observe the eighth anniversary of their tragic deaths; and

WHEREAS, on this solemn occasion, we remember these vibrant young people as they were while recognizing what they could have been; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and remember the lives of Akilah DaSilva, DeEbony Groves, Joe Perez, and Taurean Sanderlin and extend our continued sympathy and support for their loved ones and all those impacted by the Waffle House mass shooting.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.